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EXTRACT

Memorandum, by John Carter Vincent, of Conversation Between Vice President Henry A. Wallace and President Chiang Kai-shek, Chungking, June 22, 1944, 4:30 p.m.[1]

President Chiang then described what he considered to be basic in the present unfortunate military situation in China. He said that the Chinese people have fought for seven years under conditions of great hardship, and that they had expected help from abroad; that they had expected an all-out Burma campaign early this year and this would have resulted in bringing relief to the Chinese Army; and that failure to initiate an all-out Burma campaign had had a decidedly adverse effect on Chinese morale. The Chinese people felt that they had been deserted. President Chiang then referred to his conversations with President Roosevelt at Cairo. He said that President Roosevelt had promised an all-out campaign in Burma early in 1944 but that at Tehran President Roosevelt had reversed his decision, indicating that the necessary amphibious landing craft would not be available for such a campaign. President Chiang said that this reversal of decision had had a very unfortunate reaction in China. He referred to his conversation with President Roosevelt, at which time he had told President Roosevelt that, unless very early action were taken to open up Burma he could not count upon a continuance of effective Chinese resistance to the Japanese. Recent developments had proven him correct in his estimate. Mr. Wallace said that he recalled having a conversation with President Roosevelt, either personally or in a Cabinet meeting, regarding this matter but that he did not recall the details. He asked Mr. Vincent regarding the matter but Mr. Vincent said he did not have any detailed information concerning the Cairo conversations.

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[1]United States Relations with China, With Special Reference to the Period 1944-1949 (Department of State Publication 3573; August 1949), p. 551.